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Social Science

SSLC 2025-26 SURE A PLUS

PUBLIC OPINION IN DEMOCRACY

1.Do the authorities seek your opinions regarding the organisation of the school anniversary celebrations? How do you give your suggestions?

• Through school parliament • Through the class representative participating in organising committee meetings •Through Class Teacher

2.What do you mean by Public opinion?

It is the general opinion of the people about the issues affecting them. It can be the position or opinion generally held by a section of society on a particular issue.

3. Explain the Characteristics of public opinion ?

$ Public opinion reflects diverse opinions. $ Public opinion is not necessarily the views and opinions of the majority of people but, is the creation of a general consensus on a topic $ Public opinion may change with the circumstances, time and new knowledge. $ Public opinion is always formed not only on political matters but also in relation to Socio-economic and cultural matters.

4.What are the factors that influence public opinion ?

Social and cultural background of individuals, attitude, belief, preconceptions, leadership skills, education .

5.Agencies that shape public opinion-

Formation of public opinion is not an automatic, highly precise or perfectly timed process. Various sections of the society express their opinion and views whenever a common issue arises in the society. In this process some comments are very much welcomed and it emerges as the public opinion. Thus public opinion is formed through formal and informal processes.

6.The first stage of public opinion formation begins with families. Evaluate this statement and make a note.

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Child's socialisation process starts from the family and the traditional beliefs and perceptions of the family, influences opinion formation. The child is a participant or a witness in the discussion held in the family in which politics, beliefs, religion, literature, etc. are all topics. In this way, the family has the first place in the formation of the child's opinion on various issues.

7.Briefly explain the role of Educational institutions in shaping and developing public opinion

It shapes and develops knowledge, rights, duties, scientific thinking, critical thinking etc in Children. All knowledge and skills are acquired by the child through educational institutions. The process of education helps a person to form an independent and rational opinion. Educational institutions play an important role in shaping children's understanding of various subjects. Activities in school such as school parliament, club activities etc act as a platform in opinion formation.

8.Peer groups and public opinion -

Peer group members share almost common characteristics in terms of personality, attitudes and behaviour which are important factors influencing public opinion formation. They all share some common characteristics in their personal experiences and social influences. Peer group members can influence each other on the policies of the government, various social issues and political parties. Such peer group discussions are helpful in eliciting common opinions, correcting existing ones and arriving at correct opinions.

9.Role of different types of Media in shaping public opinion-

Media play an important role in shaping public opinion. News, discussions and advertising programmes available through traditional media and new media have a great influence on people. Media can bring an issue to public attention and shape public opinion on it.

Newspapers- play an important role in bringing all political and social events before the public. Newspapers are able to strengthen the democratic process by bringing

current issues to the people and at the same time bring the opinion of the people to the government.

Radio & Television - Radio and television are serving as a mirror to social life. While the print media considers only the literate community, radio and television play an important role in forming the ideas and knowledge among the illiterate community. It shares the opinions and thoughts of the people in the society about various policies and programmes of the government.

10.What are the preventive measures that we should take against the spread of such fake news and messages?

• Finding the real source in order to find the validity of the news and messages. • If recognised as fake news and messages, do not share it with others. • Inform official system such as cyber cell.

11.Differentiate Media literacy and Digital literacy

Media literacy is the ability to access, analyse, evaluate, create new messages and communicate the messages received through various forms of media. Content creation and the way it shapes our perceptions and how we critically interpret news and messages are all included in this.

Digital literacy is the ability to find information from the digital world and evaluate them efficiently using digital equipment and technology. This includes basic computer knowledge, effective use of internet, navigation of digital platforms, critical evaluation of online content, cyber awareness, etc.

12.Role of Political parties in mobilising public opinion -

Both ruling and the opposition parties play a role in shaping public opinion. The main objective of political parties is to make the public think about common public issues politically.. Ruling parties try to propagate government policies in their favour. They also devise appropriate campaign strategies. On the other hand, the opposition parties bring the shortcomings and failures of the administration. They undertake campaigns and struggles that help in the formation of public opinion against the government. All political parties have an interest in promoting their own ideals

during election stages. Every party tries to mobilise the people in its favour by presenting their views and ideas and makes them involved in public affairs and ensure participation in the electoral process. During the election campaign parties try to sway public opinion in their favour. When political parties go overboard and engage in personal attacks and negative propaganda, the election commission intervenes and controls them.

13.Various methods adopted by political parties to shape public opinion

- Conference, demonstrations, rallies and seminars are all organised
- Publishes journals, pamphlets, manifestos, posters, write ups etc.

14.Elucidate the role of Various social institutions and organisations in shaping public opinion-

Religious institutions, caste-religious organisations, student movements, youth movements, women's equality movements, trade unions, human rights movements, merchant associations, environmental organisation etc. play their own role in shaping public opinion.

15.Opinion polls and public opinion- Opinion polls are a very effective way to gather information about public attitudes and opinions on various social, cultural, political and economic issues. A sample of population is approached for their views regarding specific issues. By using the information public opinion can be formed. There are various professional agencies working to conduct opinion polls.

16.How could Art, literature, cinema form strong public opinion ?

Art, literature, cinema of each era influence the formation of the public opinion of the times. 'Patta Bakki', 'Adukkalayil Ninnu Arangathekku' and so on were some of the plays which had a significant role in changing the social life of Kerala. Literary works of Rabindranath Tagore, Subramania Bharathi and Vallathol Narayana Menon inspired Indian freedom movement. The art forms such as Ottanthullal, Chakyarkoothu, etc could form strong public opinion against the then existing social evils, customs and thereby ignite social revolution.

17.Factors that hinder the formation of public opinion

*Illiteracy - Illiterate people have only limited knowledge about public issues. They may not have the capacity to form rational opinions.

*Digital Divide - The digital divide is the gap in accessing modern information technology such as the internet, computer, and smartphone. This hinders the formation of effective public opinion.

*Poverty - Groups experiencing poverty are often isolated from public affairs. Hence, they are not able to participate in the formation of public opinion appropriately.

*Unhealthy political activity and lack of democracy in political parties - Partisanship in political activities and polarisation among the people are factors that hinder the formation of public opinion.

* Unhealthy practices during the election campaigns - Unhealthy practices that are used to influence voters during election times often hinder the formation of real public opinion.

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